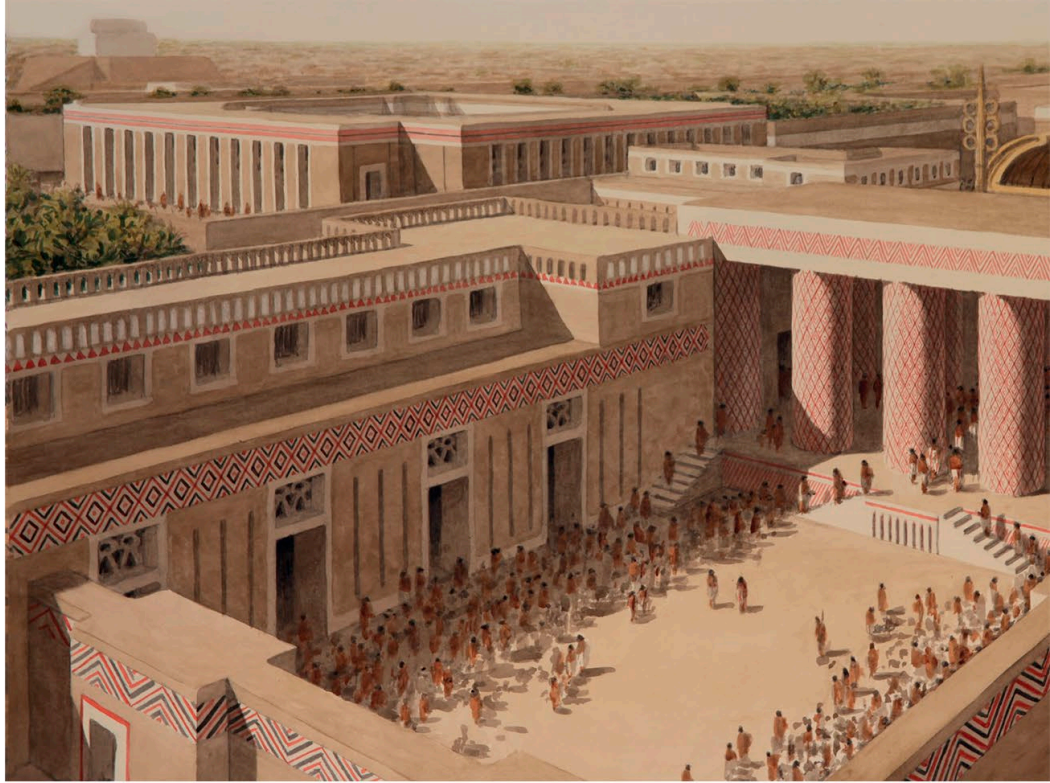


c. 4100–2900 BCE CITY-STATES APPEAR IN MESOPOTAMIA

One of the earliest civilizations, Sumer, emerged as settlements appeared in the region between the Tigris and Euphrates rivers in present-day Iraq. Many of these villages developed into larger urban centres. The most important of these was Uruk, the first true city, which became the political and cultural centre of the region. At its height, the city-state of Uruk had up to 80,000 inhabitants, about half of whom lived in the city itself.

▷ White temple at Uruk, modern visualization



c. 5500–2800 BCE **Settlements in the Indus Valley** mark the beginnings of the early Harappan Civilization

10,000 BCE

c. 8000 BCE **Walled settlements**, such as Jericho, arise, offering defence against flood as well as invasion

c. 5000–3520 BCE **Small villages are established** during the Early Jōmon period in Japan

The first metals to be worked were gold and copper



c. 9500 BCE

TEMPLES OF GOBEKLI TEPE

A complex of circles of stone pillars was constructed in Anatolia, southeastern Turkey, at the site known now as Göbekli Tepe. The intricately carved, T-shaped pillars were set in sockets cut into the rock floor. They were arranged in circular layouts believed to have had a religious or ritual purpose, making them the earliest known religious structures in the world.

◁ Circular temple at Göbekli Tepe